Yaara Aybar

LinkedIn | Website

EDUCATION

Yale University

B.S. in Cognitive Science; Advanced Language Certificate in Hebrew

- Course Concentration: Human-Computer Interaction
- Leadership: Elected Senator, Yale College Council; President, Yale Friends of Israel; VP of Standards and Education, Kappa Kappa Gamma; Coding Instructor, Code Haven

EXPERIENCE

Microsoft Surface

Software Program Manager (2024-Present)

- Coordinated software delivery of Surface Pro 12” and Surface Laptop 13” (both editions) with special focus on Windows bug investigation and fix delivery.
- Founded an AI learning initiative that equipped 100+ colleagues to apply Copilot workflows through hands-on sessions and prototype demos.
- Led two Microsoft hackathon projects: *Sixth Sense*, a notification assistant preventing device disruptions, and *Pathfinder*, an AI-powered platform for dev-self-host workflows.

Software Program Manager Intern (Summer 2023)

- Managed delivery of critical Surface firmware updates to achieve Intel Evo certification.
- Led early software program planning for Surface Pro Keyboard in Dune color.

Microsoft Azure

Explore Intern (Summer 2022)

- Created first customer onboarding and technical documentation for Azure Usage Billing.

Yale Psychiatry

Research Intern (Summer 2021)

- Conducted EEG and MRI studies and contributed research to a peer-reviewed paper.

PROJECTS

- **Seeing the Future Self (Yale Senior Thesis)**: Conducted empirical research on the impact of viewing aged visualizations on future self-continuity, temporal discounting, and long-term behavior, integrating an age transformation model in a Python web app.
- **AI-Assisted Clinical Decision Support (Course Project)**: Designed FDA-aligned software for non-small cell lung cancer patients to explore radiation treatment plans.
- **Digital Escape Rooms**: designed games used by classrooms worldwide and published on Breakout EDU.

SKILLS

- Programming: Python, Java, HTML and CSS, Racket, R
- AI: GitHub Copilot Certified; Microsoft Azure AI Fundamentals Certified; Copilot CLI
- Tools: Visual Studio Code, Azure DevOps, Project Professional, Power Platform Certified